



i.Scribe 1.88

An open source cross-platform e-mail client, more popular with OSes other than Windows, i.Scribe is just 790 KB! It requires no installation, and can be carried around on a thumb drive. You can even take it to a Linux computer and continue checking your mail. It supports the POP3, IMAP, and LDAP protocols.

i.Scribe has a simple three-pane interface, with the mail folders at the left, mails at the top right, and message content at the bottom right. You are guided by a wizard to create your account on your first run. This version being free, you are limited to creating only one account, and once we did create one, we had a hard time trying to delete it.

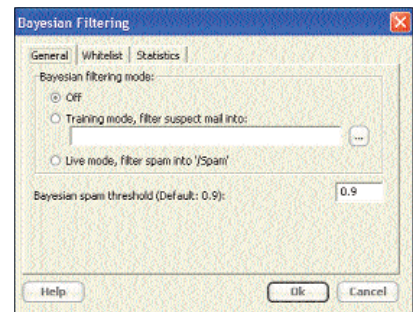
You can only compose messages in plain-text, but you can view HTML messages. i.Scribe uses its secure internal engine to render HTML, but can

also use Internet Explorer's HTML rendering engine.

i.Scribe does not provide a sufficient number of options in its mail search—you can only provide one search term, and search in only one field, such as To, From, Subject, etc. Message rules are also inflexible, and it takes a while to understand how to set up a certain rule.

The powerful Bayesian spam filter can effectively discard spam and allow only good e-mail to end up in your Inbox and the duplicate message filter looks for and deletes duplicate messages.

Small doesn't mean less, because i.Scribe even has PIM features such as a Calendar, which lets you share your appointments with others. You can also expand i.Scribe's functionality using the large number of community-created plugins.



i.Scribe's Bayesian Filter keeps spam at bay



Mulberry 4.0.6

Here's a powerful mail client that supports almost every platform. It supports all the protocols expected of an e-mail client, but Mulberry fails miserably when it comes to simplicity of interface and ease of use. It took us a considerable amount of time to figure how to even configure a new mail account.

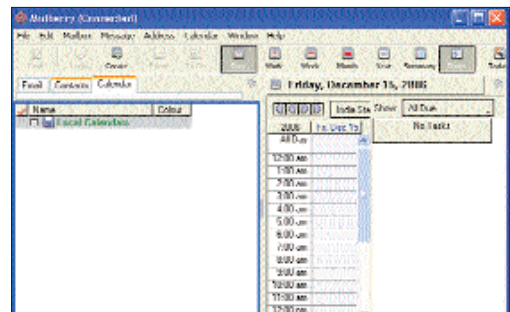
The e-mail composer supports messages with plain-text, rich text, and HTML formatting. The text macros let you specify commonly-used text, so that you can quickly insert such text into your messages using hotkeys. The Speak mail feature uses the

installed text-to-speech engine in the OS to read your e-mail to you.

The search engine is simple yet powerful, and you can also save search criteria for future use.

Mulberry has taken care of security and privacy. It supports OpenPGP and S/MIME message encryption in addition to TLS/SSL.

From this version on, Mulberry also comes with calendaring support. It's free software—so you can always give it a try!



Mulberry even comes with PIM features



Opera Mail Client

Opera Mail Client was the only e-mail client we tested that was integrated with a browser rather than being a separate piece of software. While all the received e-mails are stored in the Received folder, mails with attachments are also categorised according to the attachment type—such as Documents, Images, Music, Videos, and Archives, for faster retrieval.

Integration within Opera does have its advantages. It can accept all kinds of RSS as well as Atom feeds, and these are well-sorted into folders—one per feed. This is the only e-mail client that supports all the required protocols—POP3, IMAP, NNTP, and even Chat (IRC).

The Opera mail composer is still primitive, and does not support HTML. The lack of HTML and JavaScript support however means that this mail client is well-protected from viruses. Integration with the Opera browser also allows you to create a new mail from just about anywhere within a window in the browser—

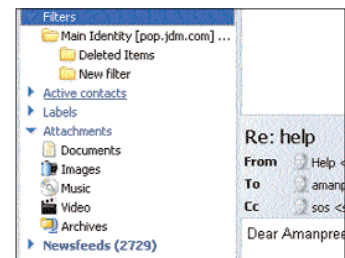
just select text, right-click, and click on "Send by mail."

The search option lets you specify very basic search criteria. Ditto for the message rules. Opera creates folders when you create a filter, and filtered messages are copied to this folder. You can create filters within filters to refine the categorisation of your mail. The spam filter is Bayesian, meaning it keeps learning.

The wizards let you import mail easily. E-mails can be imported from Eudora, Opera, OE, Netscape, and Thunderbird. Unlike previous versions, versions post-9.02 don't crash while importing Thunderbird mail.

You can take notes and send them as e-mails if required. This is the only PIM feature to be seen here. The e-mail storage location cannot be easily changed, and you need to go into the advanced configuration options to do that.

Opera Mail Client is a good client overall, but you may probably use it only if you use the Opera browser.



Mails are sorted according to filters and attachment types